

Tuesday, 21 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

25° 17°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

26° 14°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

24° 16°

GLASGOW

Overcast

24° 15°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 Very sad news this morning, as football legend Kevin Keegan has died at the age of 75.**
The former England captain and manager, who played for Liverpool and Newcastle United, revealed he had been diagnosed with stage four cancer just seven weeks ago. He was a truly cherished figure in British football.
OBITUARY · UK
- 2 The parents of a student who died from meningitis B are backing new vaccine advice, urging action so no more families endure their pain.**
Meg Draper was just 18 when she tragically died of the illness, weeks after starting university. They hope her story will encourage greater awareness and uptake of the MenB vaccine.
HEALTH · UK
- 3 A woman has bravely waived her right to anonymity to share her fears that her rapist could be released early from prison.**
Jade Belgrove has spoken out about her experience, highlighting the deep emotional impact and ongoing anxiety faced by victims. Her story brings a vital perspective to discussions around sentencing and victim support.
JUSTICE · UK
- 4 Residents in one area have been told they must pay £7,000 each to fix a water pipe outside their homes, or face prosecution.**
Welsh Water says it doesn't own the pipe, leaving homeowners with just 11 days to resolve the issue. It's a situation causing huge concern and financial strain for those affected.
CONSUMER · UK
- 5 The recent hot weather has revealed the incredible outline of a 'lost' 17th Century garden in parched grass.**
The Great Parterre, an ornate garden designed in 1699, has reappeared due to the dry conditions. It's a fascinating glimpse into history, uncovered by nature itself.
HISTORY · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Get ready for some serious muscle power, as a former World's Strongest Man is set to become a Gladiator!**

Tom Stoltman, a 6ft 8in athlete from the Highlands, will be joining the cast of the popular Saturday night show for its fourth series. He's known for his incredible strength and will be a formidable addition.

ON AIR – Who do you think would make a great Gladiator?

TV · COMING UP
- 2 Bruno Mars made a triumphant return to Wembley Stadium after an eight-year absence from UK stages.**

His polished, hit-filled show was met with huge enthusiasm from fans, proving his enduring popularity. He certainly knows how to put on a spectacular performance!

ON AIR – What's the best concert you've been to recently?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK
- 3 A new drama is set to dramatise a major maternity scandal that rocked the UK.**

The series will focus on Sarah and Jack Hawkins, who were among the first to raise the alarm about the issues. It promises to be a powerful and important piece of television.

ON AIR – Are there any real-life stories you think should be made into a drama?

TV · COMING UP
- 4 Andrew Ridgeley from Wham! says their ground-breaking concerts in China 'changed lives'.**

A new documentary explores the incredible impact Wham! had on people during their historic visit. It truly opened doors and minds in a way few Western acts had before.

ON AIR – What's a band or artist that had a big impact on you?

MUSIC · COMING UP
- 5 A signed David Hockney print, found tucked away in a book, has sold for an amazing £41,000!**

The print was discovered in a book donated to a Salvation Army shop and was snapped up by an anonymous bidder. What a lucky find for someone!

ON AIR – What's the best hidden gem you've ever found?

ART · THIS WEEK

On the schedule

- 1** **It's with great sadness that we start with news from the world of football, as former England captain and manager Kevin Keegan has died at the age of 75.**

The much-loved figure, who also played for Liverpool and Newcastle, revealed he had been diagnosed with stage four cancer just seven weeks ago. He leaves behind an incredible legacy in the sport.

ON AIR – What's your favourite memory of Kevin Keegan?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 2** **In transfer news, Chelsea's reported £117 million move for Aston Villa forward Morgan Rogers is proving to be a genuine transfer window shock.**

It's certainly a hefty price tag, and everyone's wondering what Rogers will bring to Mauricio Alonso's team. It could be a game-changer for the Blues.

ON AIR – Do you think transfer fees are getting out of control in football?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 3** **Closer to home, four Scottish clubs have discovered their possible European opponents in the Champions League, Europa League, and Conference League.**

Hearts, Rangers, Motherwell, and Hibernian will all be learning their pathways as the third qualifying round draws are made. Fingers crossed for some good matchups!

ON AIR – Which Scottish club do you think will go furthest in Europe?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 4** **Ryan Fox has won his first major golf title, securing The Open Championship at Royal Birkdale.**

The New Zealander's incredible final round saw him clinch the prestigious trophy. It was a fantastic performance and a truly memorable moment in golf.

ON AIR – Did you watch The Open? What was your highlight?

GOLF · UK
- 5** **In Formula 1, George Russell's title hopes have taken a bitter blow after he crashed out at Spa.**

The incident means he now falls 50 points behind his teammate Kimi Antonelli. It's a tough pill to swallow for the British driver.

ON AIR – Do you think George Russell can still challenge for the F1 title?

F1 · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Brewing the perfect cup of tea might be less about the leaves and more about the mug.**
New research suggests that the colour and texture of your tea cup can subtly influence your perception of the tea's taste, making it seem sweeter or more robust.
- 2 The surprising pleasure of 'rearranging your bookshelves' is bringing unexpected calm to many homes.**
It seems the act of curating your literary collection, whether by colour or genre, offers a mindful moment of organisation and visual satisfaction.
- 3 Experts are noticing a trend in families creating 'homemade board game nights' with unique, self-designed games.**
This creative approach to family entertainment encourages collaboration and offers a refreshing break from screen time.
- 4 A growing number of people are finding joy in the simple act of 'darning socks' with colourful threads.**
This traditional skill is making a comeback as a sustainable and satisfying hobby, turning wear and tear into charming design features.
- 5 Scientists have found that regularly 'watching clouds drift by' can actually help improve focus and reduce stress.**
The gentle, ever-changing patterns offer a natural form of meditation, promoting a sense of calm and present-moment awareness.
- 6 The delightful art of 'collecting interesting pebbles and stones' is making a charming comeback, with many using them for craft projects.**
From painting them with intricate designs to using them in garden mosaics, these natural treasures are inspiring creativity across all ages.
- 7 A new trend sees people transforming forgotten kitchen cupboards into stylish 'mini home bars' or 'baking stations'.**
These clever conversions maximise space and add a touch of personality to the heart of the home, making daily routines a little more special.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to choose a new book, even if we know it's not the best way to pick one?

ANSWER: JUDGING IT BY ITS COVER.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before using a new tea towel for the first time. What is it?

ANSWER: WASHING IT FIRST, EVEN IF IT FEELS PERFECTLY CLEAN.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'smell' can instantly transport you back to a specific memory or a moment from your past?**
What's that one smell that, no matter where you are, immediately takes you back to a particular time or place, and what's the memory attached to it?
- **We all have those 'little everyday sounds' that are so specific to a particular kind of weather, don't we?**
What's a specific sound you associate with a certain type of weather – perhaps the plink-plonk of raindrops on a particular surface, or the unique whisper of wind through the trees – and what memories does it bring back?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of pugs is actually called a 'grumble'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that a group of squirrels is actually called a 'squadron'?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth, visible from outer space.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- There are more stars in the universe than grains of sand on all the beaches on Earth.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, equal to one hundredth of a second.
- The longest recorded flight of a chicken is 13 seconds.
- The British Royal Family officially owns all the swans in open waters across the country.
- It is impossible for most people to lick their own elbow.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.

On this day

Day 202 of the year, 163 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alberic Crescitelli; Christian feast day: Albert John Luthuli (Episcopal Church); Christian feast day: Arbogast; Christian feast day: Barhadbesciabas. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1948 — Cat Stevens, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1984 — Liam Ridgewell, English footballer
- 1990 — Jason Roy, South African-English cricketer
- 1992 — Da\$H, American rapper
- 1988 — Chris Mitchell, Scottish footballer (died 2016)
- 1989 — Jasmine Cephas Jones, English actress and singer
- 1981 — Blake Lewis, American musician, American Idol contestant
- 1970 — Michael Fitzpatrick, American singer-songwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 1995 — Third Taiwan Strait Crisis: The People's Liberation Army begins firing missiles into the waters north of Taiwan.
- 1961 — Mercury program: Mercury-Redstone 4 Mission: Gus Grissom piloting Liberty Bell 7 becomes the second American to go into space (in a suborbital mission).
- 2024 — U.S. President Joe Biden announces he will no longer seek a second term and withdraws from the 2024 election, endorsing Vice President Kamala Harris as she launches her own presidential campaign.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1960 — Sirimavo Bandaranaike is sworn in as prime minister of Ceylon, becoming the world's first democratically elected female head of government.
- 2010 — U.S. President Barack Obama signs the Dodd–Frank Wall Street Reform and Consumer Protection Act.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2011 — NASA's Space Shuttle program ends with the landing of Space Shuttle Atlantis on mission STS-135 at NASA's Kennedy Space Center.

- 2024 — U.S. President Joe Biden announces he will no longer seek a second term and withdraws from the 2024 election, endorsing Vice President Kamala Harris as she launches her own presidential campaign.
- 1964 — A series of racial riots break out in Singapore. In the next six weeks, 23 die with 454 others injured.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 203 of the year, 162 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abd-al-Masih; Christian feast day: Anna Wang; Christian feast day: Mary Magdalene; Christian feast day: Markella. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1998 — Madison Pettis, American actress
- 1964 — David Spade, American actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1946 — Paul Schrader, American director and screenwriter
- 1960 — John Leguizamo, Colombian-American actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1947 — Albert Brooks, American actor, comedian, director, and screenwriter
- 1946 — Danny Glover, American actor, director, and producer
- 1984 — Stewart Downing, English footballer
- 1951 — Tisa Farrow, American actress and model (died 2024)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1962 — Mariner program: Mariner 1 spacecraft flies erratically several minutes after launch and has to be destroyed.
- 1951 — Soviet space dogs: Dezik and Tsygan were launched into a sub-orbital spaceflight from Kapustin Yar and became the first dogs to fly in space and the first to safely return.
- 1937 — New Deal: The United States Senate votes down President Franklin D. Roosevelt's proposal to add more justices to the Supreme Court of the United States.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1943 — World War II: Axis occupation forces violently disperse a massive protest in Athens, killing 22.
- 1937 — New Deal: The United States Senate votes down President Franklin D. Roosevelt's proposal to add more justices to the Supreme Court of the United States.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)